THE FAMILY OF GOD · LESSON 2

A Place to Belong

Ephesians 2:19 · Luke 15:11–32

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A place at the Father's table.

> *"You are no longer foreigners and strangers, but fellow citizens with God's people and also members of his household."*

Use these on your own or with a group. Read the passages, think it through, and write down what stands out.

1 Read Ephesians 2:19. Many people quietly carry questions like "Am I accepted?" and "Is there really a place for someone like me?" Which of these have you carried? Paul could have stopped at "citizens." What is the difference between having rights and having a seat at the table?

2 Read Luke 15:12–13. "He was in the right place, but he was looking at it through the wrong eyes." When have you looked at a good place in your life — your home, your family, your church — and believed something better was waiting somewhere else?

3 Read Genesis 3:5. The serpent didn't say, "God is evil." He said, "God is holding something back from you." What voices are influencing your decisions right now? How can you tell which ones are speaking for the Father?

4 Read Luke 15:18–22. The son rehearsed his speech all the way home, but the father interrupted it with a robe, a ring, and sandals. What speech about yourself have you been rehearsing to God? What do you think the Father would say back?

5 Read Luke 15:28–31. The older son never left home and still described his life as "slaving." Where do you see yourself in the older brother? Is there someone whose welcome you have found hard to celebrate?

6 Read Romans 8:15. "A servant asks, 'Am I good enough?' A son asks, 'What does my Father want?'" Which question do you ask more often? What is one way you could help make room for someone in our church family this week?